

Horizon Europe - Work Programme 2023-2025
Widening participation and strengthening the European Research Area

<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B.
<i>Financial and operational capacity and exclusion</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex C.
<i>Award criteria</i>	The criteria are described in General Annex D.
<i>Documents</i>	The documents are described in General Annex E.
<i>Procedure</i>	The procedure is described in General Annex F.
<i>Legal and financial set-up of the Grant Agreements</i>	The rules are described in General Annex G.

PRIORITISING INVESTMENTS AND REFORMS

The recent ERA Communication proposed to prioritise investments and reforms in research and innovation towards the green and digital transitions, to support the European Union's recovery from the pandemic and to increase its competitiveness, calling on the Commission to develop ambitious joint funding actions in strategic areas of common interest.

Proposals are invited against the following topic(s):

HORIZON-WIDERA-2024-ERA-01-01: Programme level collaboration between national R&I policy-makers

Specific conditions	
<i>Expected EU contribution per project</i>	The Commission estimates that an EU contribution of around EUR 2.00 million would allow these outcomes to be addressed appropriately. Nonetheless, this does not preclude submission and selection of a proposal requesting different amounts.
<i>Indicative budget</i>	The total indicative budget for the topic is EUR 6.00 million.
<i>Type of Action</i>	Coordination and Support Actions
<i>Eligibility conditions</i>	The conditions are described in General Annex B. The following exceptions apply: Legal entities established in non-associated third countries may exceptionally participate in this Coordination and support action. Due to the scope of this topic, legal entities established in non-associated

	third countries are exceptionally eligible for Union funding.
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Expected Outcome: Projects are expected to contribute to all of the following expected outcomes:

The actions funded under this topic will coordinate national and regional R&I funding programmes by pooling national resources and contributing to the alignment of national research and innovation policies. The expected outcomes:

- Identification of common research and innovation priorities agreed among the participating national and regional R&I programmes, taking into account international developments where relevant and leading to the development of coordinated R&I funding agendas;
- Implementation of multiannual joint calls, resulting in the funding of transnational collaborative R&I projects;
- Implementation of other joint activities supporting technology development, market introduction, regulatory aspects and societal uptake of results;
- Contribution to participating states meeting Global Challenges, including relevant contributions to the SDGs.

Scope: Since the introduction of the European Research Area (ERA) in 2000 and starting with Framework Programme 6 and the introduction of the ERA-NET scheme, programme level collaboration among Member States and Associated Countries and their research and innovation funding programmes has become a cornerstone of the ERA, with annual investment from Member States of more than EUR 800 million per year. More than 250 networks among research funders have been created over time, serving different research needs but always coordinating public research investments across borders and allowing researchers to apply for calls for transnational research projects funded by the participating states.

Horizon Europe introduces a new approach to incentive programme level collaboration by identifying upfront candidate European co-funded, co-programmed and institutionalised partnerships in the Strategic Plan. The first Strategic Plan also identified 5 EU missions to be supported through Horizon Europe.

Co-funding to R&I partnerships of European relevance is under Horizon Europe limited to European Partnerships identified in the Strategic Plan for Horizon Europe.

The ERA part of Horizon Europe complements this new strategic approach by providing the possibility for Member States, Associated Countries and civil society organisations such as foundations, to maintain existing and establish new collaborations on priorities of their choice, thereby continuing the spirit of the successful ERA-NET scheme, and extending it also to the domain of EU missions.